

cryptocurrency and cryptocommodity infrastructure to be built before they can reliably function.

In summation, we believe that a clearer view of this brave new world of blockchain architecture includes *cryptocurrencies*, *cryptocommodities*, and *cryptotokens*, just as we have had currencies, commodities, and finished goods and services in the preceding centuries. Be it a currency, commodity, or service, blockchain architectures help provision these digital resources in a distributed and market-based manner.

In this chapter, we focus on the most important cryptocurrencies today, including bitcoin, litecoin, ripple, monero, dash, and zcash. The next chapter covers the world of cryptocommodities and cryptotokens, the development of which has been accelerated by the launch of Ethereum and its value proposition as a decentralized world computer. Besides its status as the number two cryptoasset by network value, Ethereum has also spawned many other cryptoassets that creatively utilize its network.

While we cannot possibly cover all the cryptoassets, we will focus on those we believe will help the innovative investor gain the broadest perspective. To those entrepreneurs and developers who've created assets that we're unable to cover here, we apologize. Many amazing projects were created in the process of writing the book, and if we tried to incorporate them all the book would never have been finished. To that end, we've included a listing in the resources section to enable access to information on other cryptoassets.